

CTS tours
Experience The Real Asia

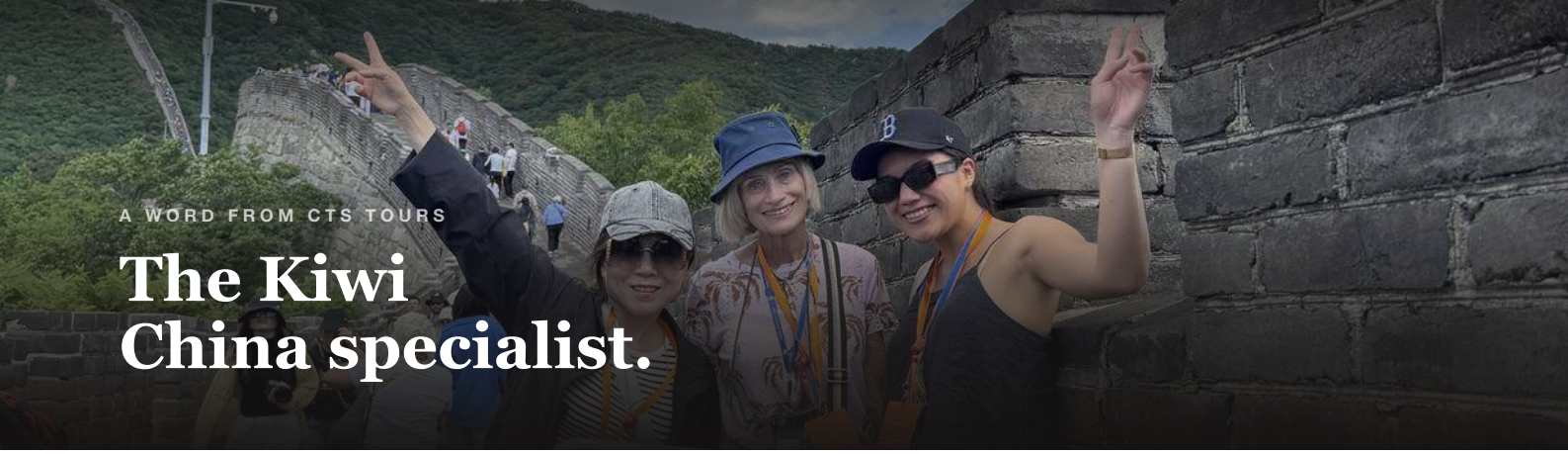
CHINA · 2027 DEPARTURES

Kiwi journeys to China 2027

28 scheduled group departures from Auckland across eight guided tours, plus 14 short China stopovers. Tours from NZ$2,699pp; stopovers from NZ$875pp.

AUCKLAND-BASED · TAANZ-BONDED · BACKED BY CHINA TRAVEL SERVICE

CTSTOURS.CO.NZ



A WORD FROM CTS TOURS

The Kiwi China specialist.

CTS Tours New Zealand is Aotearoa's dedicated China travel specialist — the local arm of China Travel Service. We are TAANZ-bonded, IATA-accredited and Auckland-based, led by Lisa Li, MNZM. We design and operate every China holiday package in-house, with direct China operations rather than reselling a third party's tour.

BASED IN
Auckland
Office at 175 Queen Street

MEMBER OF
TAANZ
Client funds held in a TAANZ-bonded trust account

AGENCY
IATA
IATA-accredited

GOOGLE RATING
4.4★
12 reviews · checked 1 Nov 2026

REAL WORDS FROM CTS TRAVELLERS

> *"The china journey was well-organized, I actually enjoyed all the moments without worrying about anything. Highly recommend the tour of tale of two cities china"*
>
> MARYAM ABSH · TALE OF TWO CITIES · JULY 2026

> *"Just came back from a tour of Xinjiang and a stopover in Xian. We had a fantastic time, the culture and scenery in Xinjiang is stunning and the tour was led by an experienced guide with excellent English. Highly recommended."*
>
> MURRAY MIDDENDORF · XINJIANG · JUNE 2026

Every review above is public on the CTS Tours Google Business profile and quoted word for word.

OUR GROUPS

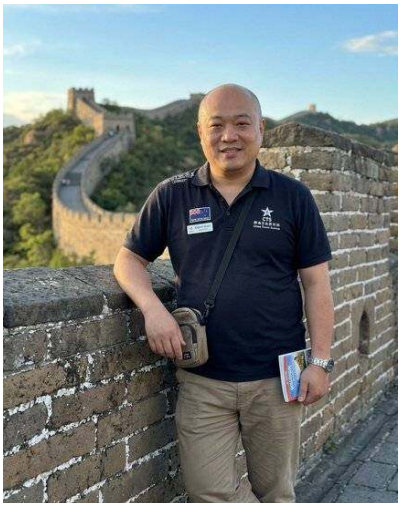
- **NZ-only groups.** Small, exclusive groups with only New Zealand travellers, for a more personalised experience.

ACCREDITED & BONDED

- TAANZ member — client funds held in a TAANZ-bonded trust account
- IATA-accredited
- Recognised by Qualmark
- Member of the Tourism Export Council of New Zealand
- Member of Tourism Industry Aotearoa
- Member of the Auckland Business Chamber

YOUR CHINA SPECIALIST

Talk to the person who built the trip.



YOUR CHINA SPECIALIST

Baker Gu

China Travel Specialist

Baker Gu is the China specialist behind CTS Tours. He personally designs and quality-checks every CTS journey, and he advises travellers directly.

When you enquire, you are not talking to a call centre — you are talking to the person who built the trip. Baker was born in China, is based in New Zealand, and speaks Mandarin, English and Cantonese.

With eight tours and 28 departures to choose between, call **0800 CTS 888** for a no-obligation conversation about your dates, your pace and what you most want to see.

CALL

0800 CTS 888

0800 287 888 · Mon–Fri 9am–5pm

EMAIL

info@ctstours.co.nz

Reply within one working day

VISIT

2F CTS House

175 Queen Street, Auckland City

ONLINE

ctstours.co.nz

Online enquiry form

REAL WORDS FROM A CTS TRAVELLER

> *"We had our China holiday planned by CTS tours. Communication was great and the tour itself was amazing. Everything was so well run and the tour guides in each city were great. The accommodation they chose and the preplanned meals organized were stand outs. Would definitely use again to organise future trips"*
>
> TESSA A · JUNE 2026

Public on the CTS Tours Google Business profile and quoted word for word.



Entry to China for NZ passports.

New Zealand passport holders can currently enter mainland China **visa-free for up to 30 days** — for tourism, business, family visits, exchange and transit, with no limit on the number of entries. **The policy is confirmed valid until 31 December 2026.**

CURRENT POLICY

30 days visa-free

For NZ passport holders, valid until 31 December 2026.

WHAT'S COVERED

Tourism, business, family visits, exchange and transit. Multiple entries, each stay up to 30 consecutive days.

WHAT TO BRING

NZ passport, a return flight booking and proof of accommodation — your CTS tour itinerary can serve as proof.

Travelling in 2027? Read this first.

The visa-free arrangement published on our website is valid **through 31 December 2026**. Every departure in this brochure leaves in 2027, and **entry requirements for 2027 travel will be whatever policy applies at the time you travel** — not what is printed here. CTS will tell every booked traveller well before departure if a visa becomes necessary, and will help with the application. Visa costs are not included in tour prices unless stated.

BEST TIME TO TRAVEL

The CTS seasonal guide recommends April–May (spring) and September–October (autumn): mild temperatures, lower crowds and clear skies across most regions. The departures in this brochure run from March to November — the calendar on page 20 lists every date.



THE CITIES

Five cities, five Chinas.

Most CTS itineraries are built around these five. The pages after them cover every other city and town on the 2027 map — 28 more.



01

Beijing 北京

An unparalleled gateway to Chinese civilisation — imperial grandeur that feels planned for you, contemporary energy that just happens. The Forbidden City is the world's largest imperial palace complex.

SEE → **FORBIDDEN CITY · GREAT WALL · TEMPLE OF HEAVEN**

TOURS Best of China · A Tale of Two Cities · China Panorama · Legacy of China

STOPOVER Beijing Express (3 days, NZ$1,450) · Beijing (5 days, NZ$2,120)



02

Xi'an 西安

Capital of thirteen dynasties, and the eastern end of the Silk Road. The star turn is the Terracotta Army. The city walls are still walkable end to end.

SEE → **TERRACOTTA ARMY · CITY WALL · MUSLIM QUARTER**

TOURS Best of China · A Tale of Two Cities · China Panorama · Silk Road · Legacy of China

STOPOVER Xi'an (3 days, NZ$945)



03

Shanghai 上海

Asia's most cosmopolitan city — skyscrapers alongside a colonial waterfront, upscale dining next to laneway cafés. The Bund's evening light show still stops people in their tracks.

SEE → **THE BUND · YU GARDEN · NANJING ROAD**

TOURS Best of China · Shanghai & Beyond · China Panorama · Legacy of China · Natural China

STOPOVER Shanghai Express (2 days, NZ$875) · Shanghai (3 days, NZ$1,060) · Shanghai & Suzhou (3 days, NZ$1,356) · Shanghai & Wuzhen (4 days, NZ$1,760)

CONTINUED OVERLEAF

Hangzhou and Chongqing — the two cities Kiwis quietly rave about back home — and then 28 more cities and towns, from the water towns around Shanghai to Guilin, Zhangjiajie, Lhasa and the Silk Road.

Beyond the big three.

Two cities that turn a China trip into something Kiwis quietly rave about back home.



04

Hangzhou 杭州

A landscape aestheticised by human hands for a thousand years. Walking the Su Causeway around West Lake before the crowds is a Chinese poem you get to stand inside.

SEE → **WEST LAKE · SU CAUSEWAY · LONGJING TEA VILLAGE**

TOURS Best of China · Shanghai & Beyond · China Panorama



05

Chongqing 重庆

A vertical mountain city that stacks streets and skyscrapers across so many levels that GPS gives up. The signature draw is a Chongqing hotpot — bolder, more molten málà than Chengdu next door.

SEE → **HONGYADONG · CIQIKOU OLD TOWN · LIZIBA MONORAIL**

TOURS China Unveiled · China Panorama · Legacy of China · Natural China

THE NEXT TWO PAGES

Every other stop on the 2027 map: 28 more cities and towns on the tours and stopovers — what to see in each, and which tours go there.

Every other stop on the map.

The five big cities are on the last two pages. These are the other 28 cities and towns the 2027 tours and stopovers visit — what you will see in each, and which tours go there. First the east and south.

EAST CHINA · THE YANGTZE DELTA

Zhujiajiao 朱家角

SEE Zhujiajiao Water Town · historic canals · stone bridges

TOURS Natural China

Suzhou 苏州

SEE Master of the Nets Garden · Panmen · Shantang Street · Humble Administrator's Garden

TOURS Shanghai & Beyond · China Panorama

STOPOVER Shanghai & Suzhou (3 days, NZ$1,356)

Wuxi 无锡

SEE Three Kingdoms City · Purple Sand Museum · Nanchang Ancient Street · Li Garden

TOURS Shanghai & Beyond

Xinshi 新市

SEE Hanfu dress-up for photos and afternoon tea · Xinshi Ancient Town

TOURS Shanghai & Beyond · China Panorama

Tongxiang · Puyuan 桐乡 · 濮院

SEE Puyuan Fashion Ancient Town · Song-style waterways

TOURS Best of China

Wuzhen 乌镇

SEE Wuzhen water town · Traditional residences and workshops

STOPOVER Shanghai & Wuzhen (4 days, NZ$1,760)

Huangshan 黄山

SEE Cable car ride up Yellow Mountain · Overnight stay atop Mt. Huangshan · Tunxi Old Street · Hongcun village

STOPOVER Huangshan (4 days, NZ$1,635)

SOUTH CHINA

Guangzhou 广州

SEE Chen Family Academy · Six Banyan Temple · Shamian Island · Canton Tower

TOURS China Unveiled

STOPOVER Guangzhou (3 days, NZ$1,399) · Guangzhou & Shenzhen (4 days, NZ$2,340)

Shenzhen 深圳

SEE Shenzhen Bay Park coastal greenway · Splendid China Folk Culture Village · Ping An Finance Centre observation deck · Dongmen Pedestrian Street

STOPOVER Guangzhou & Shenzhen (4 days, NZ$2,340)

Guilin 桂林

SEE Elephant Trunk Hill · Dongxi Alley · Li River

TOURS China Unveiled · China Panorama

STOPOVER Guilin (3 days, NZ$1,099) · Guilin & Surrounds (4 days, NZ$1,310)

Longsheng 龙胜

SEE Longji Rice Terraces · Zhuang village

TOURS China Unveiled

Yangshuo 阳朔

SEE West Street · Cruise the Li River

TOURS China Unveiled · China Panorama

And further inland.

The Yangtze, Sichuan, Yunnan and Tibet, then the Silk Road west from Xi'an to Urumqi.

CENTRAL CHINA

Yichang 宜昌
SEE Three Gorges Dam · Yangtze River Cruise

TOURS China Panorama · Legacy of China · Natural China

Fenghuang 凤凰
SEE Fenghuang Ancient Town on the Tuojiang River

TOURS China Unveiled

Zhangjiajie 张家界
SEE Tianmen Mountain glass walkway · Grand Canyon Glass Bridge · Bailong Elevator · Tianzi Mountain Cableway

TOURS China Unveiled · Natural China

STOPOVER Zhangjiajie (3 days, NZ$1,899)

SOUTHWEST CHINA

Dazu 大足
SEE Dazu Rock Carvings · Buddhist, Taoist and Confucian sculptures

TOURS Natural China

Leshan 乐山
SEE Leshan Giant Buddha · river cruise

TOURS Natural China

Kunming 昆明
SEE Stone Forest

TOURS China Panorama

Chengdu 成都
SEE giant pandas · People's Park · Taikoo Li · Kuanzhai Alley

TOURS China Panorama · Legacy of China · Natural China

STOPOVER Chengdu (3 days, NZ$1,359)

Dali 大理
SEE cruise on Erhai Lake · Three Pagodas · Dali Ancient Town · Xizhou Village market

TOURS China Panorama

Lhasa 拉萨
SEE Jokhang Temple · Barkhor Street · Sera Monastery · Potala Palace · Norbulingka

TOURS Legacy of China

NORTHWEST CHINA · THE SILK ROAD

Lanzhou 兰州
SEE Bingling Temple Grottoes · hand-pulled beef noodle making

TOURS Silk Road

Zhangye 张掖
SEE Zhangye Danxia rock formations

TOURS Silk Road

Dunhuang 敦煌
SEE Mogao Caves · Mingsha Mountain and Crescent Spring

TOURS Silk Road

Urumqi 乌鲁木齐
SEE Heavenly Lake (Tianchi)

TOURS Silk Road

Wuwei 武威
SEE Leitai Han Tomb · Confucian Temple

TOURS Silk Road

Jiayuguan 嘉峪关
SEE Hanging Great Wall · Jiayuguan Fortress

TOURS Silk Road

Turpan 吐鲁番
SEE Jiaohe Ruins · Karez Irrigation System · Flaming Mountains · Bezeklik Thousand Buddha Caves

TOURS Silk Road

HOW THIS BROCHURE WORKS

Four ways to travel with CTS.

Eight guided tours with 28 scheduled departures in 2027, fourteen short stopovers, and a tailor-made desk if none of them is quite your trip. Here is the quickest way to narrow it down.

PAGES 10–13 · 4 TOURS · 17 DEPARTURES

Discovery Collection

The classic routes, 10 to 15 days, four- and five-star hotels. This is where most first trips to China start. From **NZ$2,699pp**.

PAGES 14–17 · 4 TOURS · 11 DEPARTURES

Signature Collection

Longer and further — 17 to 27 days, five-star hotels, river cruises and first-class high-speed rail on selected journeys. From **NZ$7,999pp**.

PAGE 21 · 14 ROUTES

Stopovers

Two to five days in one Chinese city, to slot into a journey to Europe, Japan, South Korea or home to New Zealand. From **NZ$875pp**, land package.

PAGE 22

Tailor-made

Your dates, your pace, your interests. A specialist shapes the route with you before anything is booked. No obligation.

Still deciding? Start with the date, not the itinerary.

March 2027 has four Discovery departures — Best of China, A Tale of Two Cities, China Unveiled and Shanghai & Beyond. May and June add the long journeys: China Panorama, Silk Road, Legacy of China and Natural China. Later departures run through to November. The calendar on page 20 lists every date and price in one place, and pages 18–19 compare the tours side by side.



TOUR 01 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

Best of China

15 days · From Auckland · **Mar–Oct 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an · Hangzhou · Tongxiang (Puyuan) · Shanghai

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$4,080	**+NZ$800**	**22 included**	**4–5★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	12 B · 9 L · 1 D	12 nights

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 15 DAYS

1. Temple of Heaven, Tian'anmen Square, Forbidden City (or substitute Jingshan Park & Prince Gong's Mansion if tickets unavailable), Beihai Park, and the Great Wall
2. Hutong pedi-cab tour with family visit and Silk Market
3. High-speed train G89 Beijing–Xi'an (second class)
4. Terracotta Warriors with Circle Vision and Bronze Chariot; optional Tang Palace banquet show
5. Xi'an City Wall, Big Wild Goose Pagoda, Small Wild Goose Pagoda Museum, and Muslim Quarter (Huimin Street)
6. Flight to Hangzhou and Tongxiang — Puyuan Fashion Ancient Town (Song-style waterways)
7. West Lake boat tour, G20 Hangzhou International Expo Center, Meijiawu Longjing tea, Qinghefang Ancient Street
8. Shanghai: Yuyuan Garden, Bund, Nanjing Road, Lujiazui skyline corridor, World Cultural Heritage Art Exhibition Centre

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international flights from Auckland, plus all flights within China
- Hotel accommodation as specified in the itinerary
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transfer

NOT INCLUDED

Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Transportation and guide services during free time · Meals not listed in the itinerary · Optional tours and performances (e.g. acrobatic show, Tang Palace show) · Tips (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Any items not specifically mentioned as included in the itinerary

4 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
11 Mar 2027	25 Mar 2027	NZ$4,080
13 May 2027	27 May 2027	NZ$4,080

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
9 Sep 2027	23 Sep 2027	NZ$4,380
28 Oct 2027	11 Nov 2027	NZ$4,380

Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/essentials



TOUR 02 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

A Tale of Two Cities

10 days · From Auckland · **Mar–Nov 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$3,480	**+NZ$395**	**12 included**	**4★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	7 B · 5 L · 0 D	7 nights

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 10 DAYS

1. Visit the 500-year-old Temple of Heaven set in imperial gardens
2. Tour Tiananmen Square — the world's largest public square
3. Explore the Forbidden City, home to emperors for over 500 years
4. Walk the Great Wall, one of the ten wonders of the world
5. Photo stop at the iconic Bird's Nest and Water Cube Olympic Park
6. Experience old Beijing on a pedi-cab Hutong tour with a family visit
7. Discover the Terracotta Warriors — the greatest archaeological find of the century
8. Visit Xi'an's ancient City Wall and the Tang Dynasty Big Wild Goose Pagoda

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international flights from Auckland, plus all flights within China
- 4-star hotel accommodation throughout
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees as specified in the itinerary
- Meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transfers

NOT INCLUDED

Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Transportation and guide services during free time · Meals not listed in the itinerary · Tips (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Any items not specifically mentioned as included in the itinerary

6 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
18 Mar 2027	27 Mar 2027	NZ$3,480
10 Jun 2027	19 Jun 2027	NZ$3,680
21 Aug 2027	30 Aug 2027	NZ$3,680

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
2 Sep 2027	11 Sep 2027	NZ$3,680
21 Oct 2027	30 Oct 2027	NZ$3,680
14 Nov 2027	23 Nov 2027	NZ$3,680

Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/beijing-xian

TOUR 03 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

China Unveiled

14 days · From Auckland · **Mar–Jul 2027**

Guangzhou · Guilin · Yangshuo · Zhangjiajie · Fenghuang · Chongqing

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$4,999	**+NZ$950**	**21 included**	**4★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	12 B · 9 L · 0 D	11 nights in 6 cities

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 14 DAYS

1. Walk the Longji Rice Terraces and visit a Zhuang village
2. Cruise the Li River and stroll West Street in Yangshuo
3. Cross the Tianmen Mountain glass walkway and the Zhangjiajie Grand Canyon Glass Bridge
4. Ride the Bailong Elevator to Yuanjiajie, the Avatar-inspiring pillars
5. Explore Fenghuang Ancient Town on the Tuojiang River
6. See Chongqing's Hongyadong, Liziba Light Rail and Ciqikou Ancient Town

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international flights from Auckland, plus all flights within China
- 2nd-class train tickets
- Coach transportation
- English-speaking tour guide
- 4-star hotel accommodation
- Meals as stated in the itinerary

NOT INCLUDED

Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · Tips for guide and driver (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Any other items not mentioned as included

4 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
22 Mar 2027	4 Apr 2027	NZ$4,999
15 May 2027	28 May 2027	NZ$4,999

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
20 Jun 2027	3 Jul 2027	NZ$4,999
30 Jul 2027	12 Aug 2027	NZ$4,999







Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/china-unveiled



TOUR 04 · DISCOVERY COLLECTION

Shanghai & Beyond

10 days · From Auckland · **Mar–Nov 2027**

Shanghai · Suzhou · Wuxi · Xinshi Ancient Town · Hangzhou

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$2,699	**+NZ$400**	**13 included**	**4–5★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	7 B · 5 L · 1 D	7 nights

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 10 DAYS

1. Master of the Nets Garden, Panmen, and Shantang Street in Suzhou
2. Silk factory; Three Kingdoms City (warship tour & horse battle show); Purple Sand Museum; Nanchang Ancient Street in Wuxi
3. Li Garden by the lake, Pearl Exhibition Centre, and a local market day in Wuxi
4. Hanfu dress-up for photos and afternoon tea in thousand-year-old Xinshi Town
5. West Lake boat tour, Su Causeway, Leifeng Pagoda, and Hangzhou International Expo Center (G20)
6. Six Harmonies Pagoda and Longjing tea tasting at Meijiawu
7. The Bund, City God Temple quarter, World Cultural Heritage Art Exhibition Centre, and Nanjing Road
8. Optional Shanghai acrobatics show and Maglev ride (extra cost)

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international flights from Auckland, plus all flights within China
- Hotel accommodation as specified in the itinerary
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transfer

NOT INCLUDED

Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Transportation and guide services during free time · Meals not listed in the itinerary · Tips (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Optional activities (e.g. Shanghai Acrobatics Show, Maglev ride) · Any items not specifically mentioned as included in the itinerary

3 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
25 Mar 2027	3 Apr 2027	**NZ$2,699**
25 May 2027	3 Jun 2027	**NZ$2,899**
5 Nov 2027	14 Nov 2027	**NZ$2,899**

Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/shanghai-surroundings

2 DEPARTURES IN 2027



TOUR 05 · SIGNATURE COLLECTION

China Panorama

27 days · From Auckland · **May & Oct 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an · Yichang · Chongqing · Chengdu · Dali · Kunming · Guilin · Yangshuo · Shanghai · Suzhou · Xinshi · Hangzhou

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$10,899	**+NZ$2,555**	**50 included**	**5★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	24 B · 16 L · 10 D	20 hotel nights + 4 on a Yangtze cruise

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 27 DAYS

1. Walk the Juyongguan Great Wall and explore the Forbidden City
2. Discover the Terracotta Warriors in Xi'an
3. Cruise through the Yangtze River Three Gorges on a 5-star ship
4. Visit giant pandas at the Chengdu breeding base
5. Cruise the Li River to Yangshuo through karst landscapes
6. Experience West Lake and Longjing tea plantations in Hangzhou
7. Explore the classical Humble Administrator's Garden in Suzhou
8. Enjoy the Huangpu River cruise and Bund in Shanghai
9. Visit the Stone Forest in Kunming
10. Dress in traditional Hanfu at Xinshi Ancient Town

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international airfares from Auckland
- All flights within China
- 5-star hotel accommodation
- Century Yangtze River cruise or similar (5-star cruise)
- English-speaking tour guide
- National guide throughout the whole trip in China
- Entrance fees and meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transport including high-speed trains (First Class)

NOT INCLUDED

Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Transportation and guide services during free time · Meals not listed in the itinerary · Tips (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Any items not specifically mentioned as included

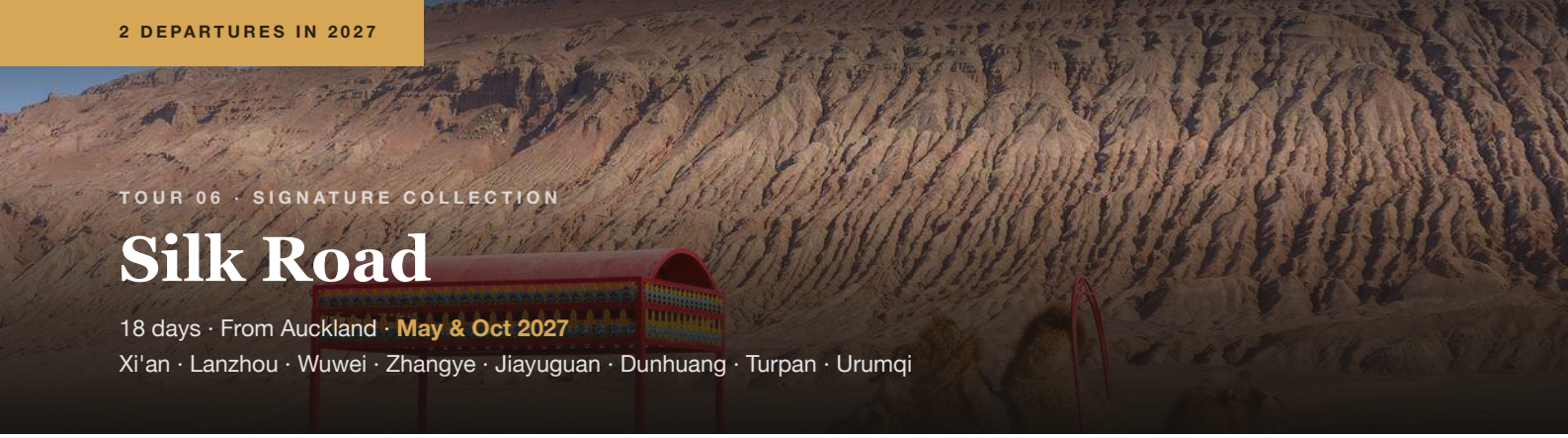
2 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
8 May 2027	3 Jun 2027	NZ$10,899
16 Oct 2027	11 Nov 2027	NZ$11,399

Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/grand-tour

2 DEPARTURES IN 2027



TOUR 06 · SIGNATURE COLLECTION

Silk Road

18 days · From Auckland · **May & Oct 2027**

Xi'an · Lanzhou · Wuwei · Zhangye · Jiayuguan · Dunhuang · Turpan · Urumqi

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$7,999	**+NZ$1,488**	**38 included**	**5★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	15 B · 11 L · 12 D	15 nights

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 18 DAYS

1. Visit Heavenly Lake (Tianchi) in the Tianshan Mountains
2. Explore Turpan's ancient Jiaohe Ruins and Karez Irrigation System
3. See the dramatic Flaming Mountains and Bezeklik Thousand Buddha Caves
4. Marvel at the world-famous Mogao Caves in Dunhuang
5. Experience the desert oasis of Mingsha Mountain and Crescent Spring
6. Walk along the Hanging Great Wall and Jiayuguan Fortress
7. Photograph the colourful Zhangye Danxia rock formations
8. Take a boat trip to the Bingling Temple Grottoes
9. Visit the Terracotta Warriors in Xi'an
10. Enjoy a free day to explore Xi'an at your own pace

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international flights from Auckland, plus all flights within China
- 5-star hotel accommodation
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transport including high-speed trains (First Class)

NOT INCLUDED

Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · China visa fee (if required) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Transportation and guide services during free time · Meals not listed in the itinerary · Tips (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Any items not specifically mentioned as included in the itinerary

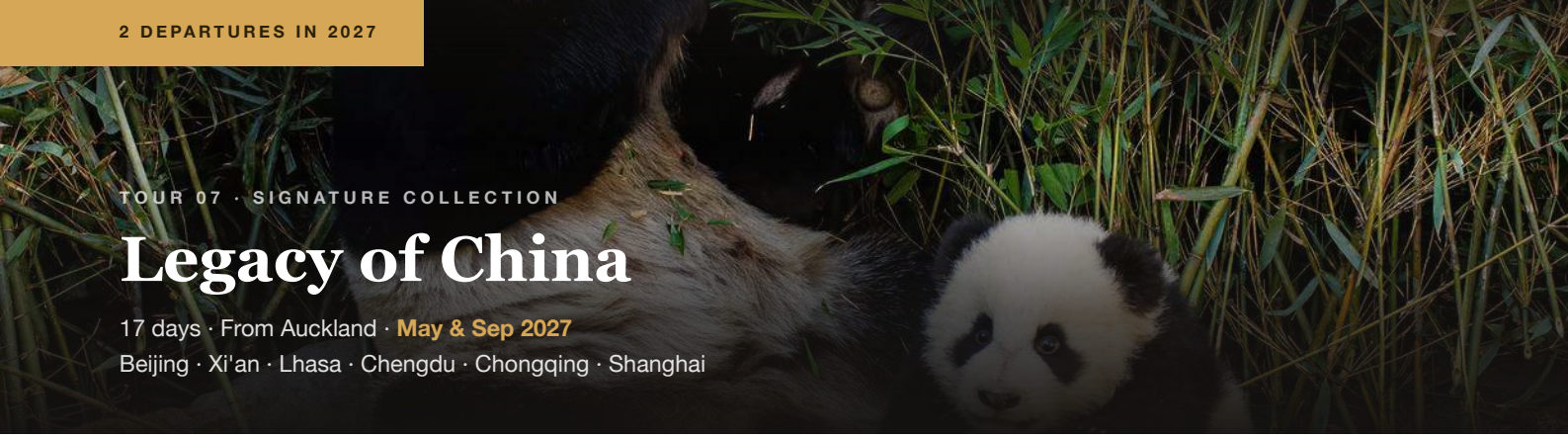
2 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
13 May 2027	30 May 2027	NZ$7,999
21 Oct 2027	7 Nov 2027	NZ$8,499

Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/silk-road

2 DEPARTURES IN 2027



TOUR 07 · SIGNATURE COLLECTION

Legacy of China

17 days · From Auckland · **May & Sep 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an · Lhasa · Chengdu · Chongqing · Shanghai

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$9,999	**+NZ$2,410**	**31 included**	**5★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	14 B · 7 L · 10 D	11 hotel nights + 3 on a Yangtze cruise

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 17 DAYS

1. Temple of Heaven with optional Tai Chi among locals; Tian'anmen Square and Forbidden City (see itinerary for Monday closure & ticket substitution)
2. Walk the Mutianyu Great Wall; jade craft workshop; Summer Palace gardens
3. High-speed train Beijing–Xi'an (G55, first class); Muslim Quarter; dumpling banquet with Tang Dynasty dance
4. Terracotta Warriors, ceramics and lacquerware workshop, Xi'an Ancient City Wall
5. Lhasa: Jokhang Temple, Barkhor Street, Sera Monastery debates, Potala Palace, Norbulingka, Tibetan cultural dinner
6. Chengdu pandas; first-class rail to Chongqing; Victoria Cruises Yangtze Three Gorges (Shennü or Shennong Stream excursions)
7. Three Gorges Dam; evening flight to Shanghai; Yuyuan, silk factory, Bund, Huangpu River night cruise and Shanghai dinner
8. Leisure time in Shanghai before your return to New Zealand

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international flights from Auckland, plus all flights within China
- 5-star hotel accommodation (and international-standard Yangtze cruise) as specified in the itinerary
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transport including high-speed trains (first class where specified)

NOT INCLUDED

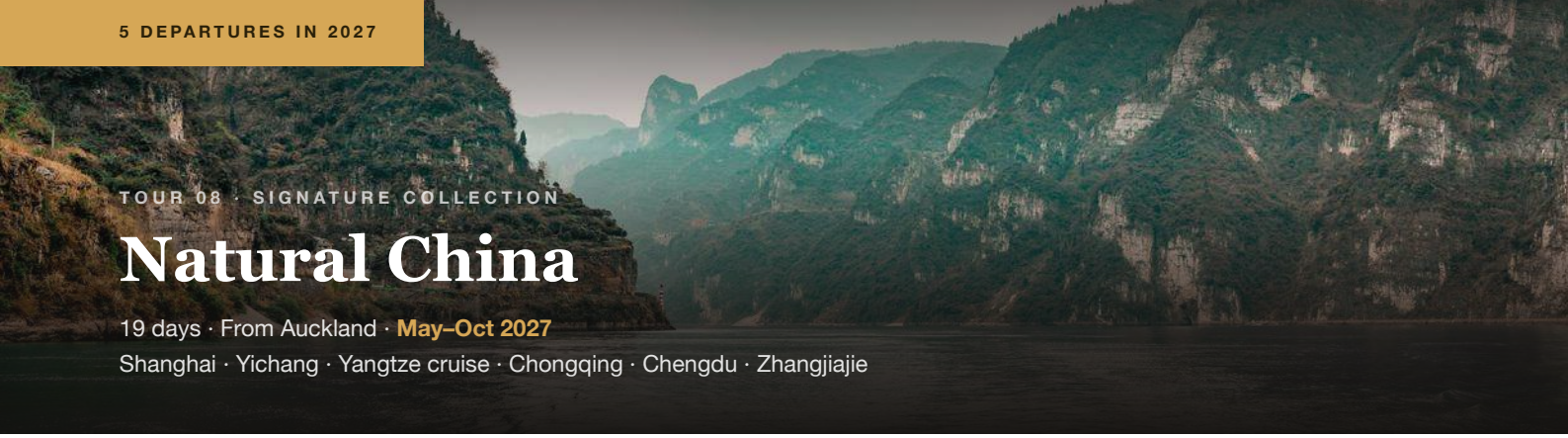
Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Transportation and guide services during free time · Meals not listed in the itinerary · Tips (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Any items not specifically mentioned as included in the itinerary

2 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
28 May 2027	13 Jun 2027	NZ$9,999
3 Sep 2027	19 Sep 2027	NZ$10,499

Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/imperial-heritage



TOUR 08 · SIGNATURE COLLECTION

Natural China

19 days · From Auckland · **May–Oct 2027**

Shanghai · Yichang · Yangtze cruise · Chongqing · Chengdu · Zhangjiajie

FROM	SOLO ROOM	MEALS	HOTELS
NZ$7,999	**+NZ$2,755**	**44 included**	**5★**
per person, twin share	private room, full tour	16 B · 13 L · 15 D	12 hotel nights + 4 on a Yangtze cruise

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 19 DAYS

1. Cruise the Yangtze River through the Three Gorges from Yichang to Chongqing
2. Visit Zhujiajiao Water Town, the UNESCO-listed Dazu Rock Carvings and the Leshan Giant Buddha
3. See giant pandas and explore Chengdu's People's Park, Taikoo Li and Kuanzhai Alley
4. Ride the Bailong Elevator and Tianzi Mountain Cableway in Zhangjiajie National Forest Park
5. Walk the Glass Skywalk and Guigu Plank Walk at Tianmen Mountain
6. Take high-speed trains from Chongqing to Chengdu and on to Zhangjiajie
7. Visit Shanghai's Yuyuan Garden, the Bund and enjoy a Huangpu River night cruise
8. See Chongqing's Liziba Monorail Station, Ciqikou and Hongyadong night scenery
9. Enjoy an optional Sichuan Opera face-changing performance in Chengdu

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international airfares from Auckland
- All flights within China
- 5-star hotel accommodation
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transport including high-speed trains (First Class)

NOT INCLUDED

Flights within New Zealand to Auckland (connecting flights from other NZ cities are quoted separately) · Travel insurance (strongly recommended) · Personal expenses · Transportation and guide services during free time · Meals not listed in the itinerary · Tips (suggested NZD $10 per day per person) · Any items not specifically mentioned as included

5 SCHEDULED DEPARTURES IN 2027

DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	PER PERSON
30 May 2027	17 Jun 2027	NZ$7,999
13 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027	NZ$7,999
8 Aug 2027	26 Aug 2027	NZ$7,999
5 Sep 2027	23 Sep 2027	NZ$7,999
31 Oct 2027	18 Nov 2027	NZ$7,999

Prices per person, twin share, NZ dollars. Scheduled group departures — confirm at booking. Covers land hotel accommodation and the Three Gorges cruise.

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/landscapes

Four tours, side by side.

The classic routes, from a 10-day Beijing and Xi'an loop to a 15-day sweep from Beijing to Shanghai. Compare them in one glance.

	Best of China 15 DAYS	A Tale of Two Cities 10 DAYS	China Unveiled 14 DAYS	Shanghai & Beyond 10 DAYS
DEPARTURES	4 in 2027 Mar–Oct	6 in 2027 Mar–Nov	4 in 2027 Mar–Jul	3 in 2027 Mar–Nov
DURATION	15 days	10 days	14 days	10 days
ROUTE	Beijing · Xi'an · Hangzhou · Tongxiang (Puyuan) · Shanghai	Beijing · Xi'an	Guangzhou · Guilin · Yangshuo · Zhangjiajie · Fenghuang · Chongqing	Shanghai · Suzhou · Wuxi · Xinshi Ancient Town · Hangzhou
MEALS	22 included 12 B · 9 L · 1 D	12 included 7 B · 5 L · 0 D	21 included 12 B · 9 L · 0 D	13 included 7 B · 5 L · 1 D
HOTELS	4–5★ 12 nights	4★ 7 nights	4★ 11 nights in 6 cities	4–5★ 7 nights
FROM PRICE	**NZ$4,080pp**	**NZ$3,480pp**	**NZ$4,999pp**	**NZ$2,699pp**
SOLO ROOM	+NZ$800	+NZ$395	+NZ$950	+NZ$400

From prices are the lowest of each tour's 2027 departures; every date and price is on the calendar. Prices are per person, twin share, in New Zealand dollars. Hotels are "or similar" and ratings follow local standards. Checked against the CTS tour catalogue on 1 November 2026.







Longer journeys, side by side.

Four Signature journeys, from 17 to 27 days, with river cruises and first-class high-speed rail on selected itineraries.

	China Panorama 27 DAYS	Silk Road 18 DAYS	Legacy of China 17 DAYS	Natural China 19 DAYS
DEPARTURES	2 in 2027 May & Oct	2 in 2027 May & Oct	2 in 2027 May & Sep	5 in 2027 May–Oct
DURATION	27 days	18 days	17 days	19 days
ROUTE	Beijing · Xi'an · Yichang · Chongqing · Chengdu · Dali · Kunming · Guilin · Yangshuo · Shanghai · Suzhou · Xinshi · Hangzhou	Xi'an · Lanzhou · Wuwei · Zhangye · Jiayuguan · Dunhuang · Turpan · Urumqi	Beijing · Xi'an · Lhasa · Chengdu · Chongqing · Shanghai	Shanghai · Yichang · Yangtze cruise · Chongqing · Chengdu · Zhangjiajie
MEALS	50 included 24 B · 16 L · 10 D	38 included 15 B · 11 L · 12 D	31 included 14 B · 7 L · 10 D	44 included 16 B · 13 L · 15 D
HOTELS	5★ 20 hotel nights + 4 on a Yangtze cruise	5★ 15 nights	5★ 11 hotel nights + 3 on a Yangtze cruise	5★ 12 hotel nights + 4 on a Yangtze cruise
FROM PRICE	**NZ$10,899pp**	**NZ$7,999pp**	**NZ$9,999pp**	**NZ$7,999pp**
SOLO ROOM	+NZ$2,555	+NZ$1,488	+NZ$2,410	+NZ$2,755

From prices are the lowest of each tour's 2027 departures; every date and price is on the calendar. Prices are per person, twin share, in New Zealand dollars. Hotels are "or similar" and ratings follow local standards. Checked against the CTS tour catalogue on 1 November 2026.

Not sure which one?

Reply to any CTS email or call the Auckland office, and the team will walk you through it. We'll ask about timing and any dietary or mobility considerations — then match you to the right departure. **0800 CTS 888 · info@ctstours.co.nz**

Every 2027 departure, in date order.

28 scheduled group departures from Auckland. Prices are per person, twin share, in New Zealand dollars. Dates and prices are from the CTS tour catalogue, checked on 1 November 2026 — confirm availability at booking.

	DEPARTS AUCKLAND	RETURNS	TOUR	LENGTH	PER PERSON
Mar	11 Mar 2027	25 Mar 2027	Best of China	15 days	NZ$4,080
	18 Mar 2027	27 Mar 2027	A Tale of Two Cities	10 days	NZ$3,480
	22 Mar 2027	4 Apr 2027	China Unveiled	14 days	NZ$4,999
	25 Mar 2027	3 Apr 2027	Shanghai & Beyond	10 days	NZ$2,699
May	8 May 2027	3 Jun 2027	China Panorama	27 days	NZ$10,899
	13 May 2027	27 May 2027	Best of China	15 days	NZ$4,080
	13 May 2027	30 May 2027	Silk Road	18 days	NZ$7,999
	15 May 2027	28 May 2027	China Unveiled	14 days	NZ$4,999
	25 May 2027	3 Jun 2027	Shanghai & Beyond	10 days	NZ$2,899
	28 May 2027	13 Jun 2027	Legacy of China	17 days	NZ$9,999
	30 May 2027	17 Jun 2027	Natural China	19 days	NZ$7,999
Jun	10 Jun 2027	19 Jun 2027	A Tale of Two Cities	10 days	NZ$3,680
	13 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027	Natural China	19 days	NZ$7,999
	20 Jun 2027	3 Jul 2027	China Unveiled	14 days	NZ$4,999
Jul	30 Jul 2027	12 Aug 2027	China Unveiled	14 days	NZ$4,999
Aug	8 Aug 2027	26 Aug 2027	Natural China	19 days	NZ$7,999
	21 Aug 2027	30 Aug 2027	A Tale of Two Cities	10 days	NZ$3,680
Sep	2 Sep 2027	11 Sep 2027	A Tale of Two Cities	10 days	NZ$3,680
	3 Sep 2027	19 Sep 2027	Legacy of China	17 days	NZ$10,499
	5 Sep 2027	23 Sep 2027	Natural China	19 days	NZ$7,999
	9 Sep 2027	23 Sep 2027	Best of China	15 days	NZ$4,380
Oct	16 Oct 2027	11 Nov 2027	China Panorama	27 days	NZ$11,399
	21 Oct 2027	30 Oct 2027	A Tale of Two Cities	10 days	NZ$3,680
	21 Oct 2027	7 Nov 2027	Silk Road	18 days	NZ$8,499
	28 Oct 2027	11 Nov 2027	Best of China	15 days	NZ$4,380
	31 Oct 2027	18 Nov 2027	Natural China	19 days	NZ$7,999
Nov	5 Nov 2027	14 Nov 2027	Shanghai & Beyond	10 days	NZ$2,899
	14 Nov 2027	23 Nov 2027	A Tale of Two Cities	10 days	NZ$3,680



CHINA STOPOVER

Turn the transit into the trip.

Flying to Europe, Japan, South Korea or home to New Zealand? Add a short guided stay of two to five days in one Chinese city — hotel, guide, transfers and admissions arranged. CTS checks the published land package against your actual flights before confirmation.

2 days	Shanghai Express	NZ$875
3 days	Xi'an	NZ$945
3 days	Shanghai	NZ$1,060
3 days	Guilin	NZ$1,099
3 days	Shanghai & Suzhou	NZ$1,356
3 days	Chengdu	NZ$1,359
3 days	Guangzhou	NZ$1,399
3 days	Beijing Express	NZ$1,450
3 days	Zhangjiajie	NZ$1,899
4 days	Guilin & Surrounds	NZ$1,310
4 days	Huangshan	NZ$1,635
4 days	Shanghai & Wuzhen	NZ$1,760
4 days	Guangzhou & Shenzhen	NZ$2,340
5 days	Beijing	NZ$2,120

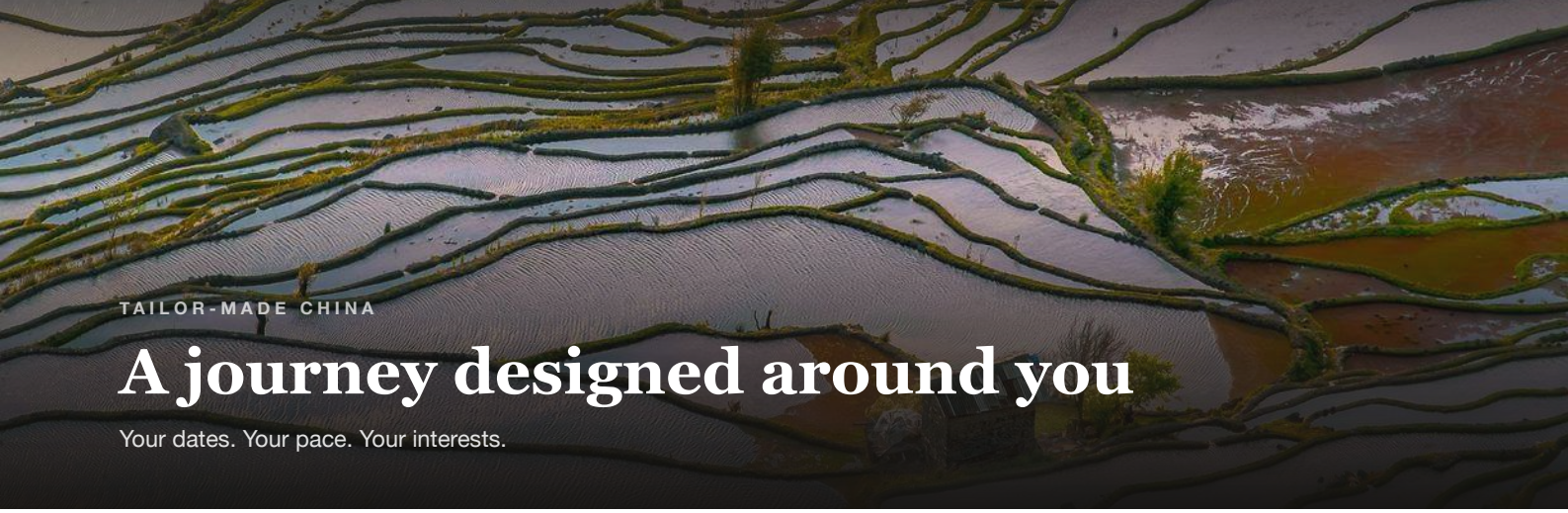
TYPICALLY INCLUDED

- 4-star hotel accommodation
- Meals as specified
- English-speaking guide
- Land transfers
- Admission to scheduled attractions

Are flights included?

"Do not assume they are. Check the Included and Not Included sections on the individual tour page. International airfare, through-ticketing and connection changes are confirmed separately unless a product explicitly states otherwise."

In plain terms: stopovers are a land package and the international airfare is arranged separately. Check the Included and Not Included list on the route you want, or ask us and we'll price the flights with it. Per person, twin share.



TAILOR-MADE CHINA

A journey designed around you

Your dates. Your pace. Your interests.

Tailor-made China. Your kind of journey. If none of the eight tours in this brochure is quite your trip, tell our Auckland specialists what you love, and we'll help shape a China or Asia holiday that feels like you.

HOW IT WORKS

1 **Tell us your ideas**

A few details are enough to begin. Tell us what matters most to you.

2 **Shape it together**

Your specialist helps refine the route, pace, hotels and budget.

3 **Confirm your journey**

Review your proposal, inclusions and availability before booking.

No obligation. A real specialist, from the first conversation.

Start planning at **ctstours.co.nz/tailor-made**, or call **0800 CTS 888** to talk it through with a China specialist.

NOT SURE YET?

Not sure about dates or destinations? Leave them flexible. Your specialist will help you work it out. Submitting the enquiry form does not make a booking.



SHOPPING

Your shopping time is yours.

No compulsory shopping stops — your shopping time is yours. Where a CTS itinerary includes a visit to a local speciality store or workshop, there is no obligation to buy and no minimum spend.

WHERE OUR ITINERARIES ACTUALLY PUT YOU

- **Shanghai** — Nanjing Road and Yuyuan Garden are on the Best of China itinerary; Nanjing Road is also on Shanghai & Beyond.
- **Xi'an** — the Muslim Quarter (Huimin Street), on Best of China and A Tale of Two Cities.
- **Beijing** — the Silk Market, with the hutong pedi-cab tour, on Best of China and A Tale of Two Cities.
- **Chongqing** — Ciqikou ancient town, on China Unveiled and Natural China.

Where an itinerary does include a silk, jade or pearl workshop — and several do — it is named in the day-by-day schedule on ctstours.co.nz, so you can read it before you book rather than discover it on the coach.





Five things Kiwis get wrong.

China moves fast, especially in the cities. A few things to sort before you fly.

01 Mobile payment is the default.

Download Alipay or WeChat Pay before you fly — both now support international NZ-issued cards. In the big cities almost every transaction is a QR code. Rural areas and smaller shops still prefer cash, so carry some RMB too.

02 Google won't work. Baidu will.

Google Maps is unreliable inside China. Use Baidu Maps or Gaode Maps for navigation. For menu translation, download Pleco — it works fully offline and reads menus through the camera.

03 Set up a VPN before you leave.

Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp, YouTube and Gmail all face restrictions. Install and test a VPN on your phone before you leave New Zealand — or embrace the digital break.

04 Basic Mandarin goes a long way.

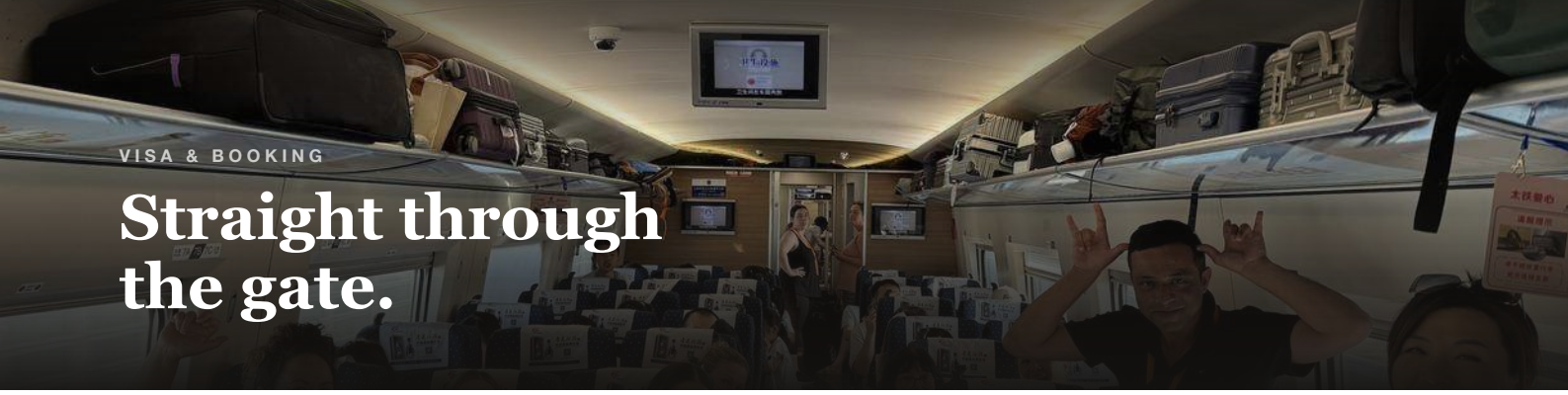
Nǐ hǎo (hello), xièxie (thank you) and duōshǎo qián (how much) is 90% of the effort. Locals genuinely appreciate the try, and it turns transactions into small conversations.

05 Tell your bank you're going.

New Zealand card fraud systems can block a first Chinese ATM withdrawal automatically. A quick call to your bank ahead of time avoids getting locked out on day one.

ONE THING YOU DO NOT NEED TO SORT

Your CTS guide handles tickets, queues, transfers and the language at every stop on the itinerary. These five are simply the things that sit outside a guide's reach — your phone, your bank and your own free afternoons.



VISA & BOOKING

Straight through the gate.

30 Days visa-free for NZ passport holders

Valid until 31 December 2026. Tourism, business, family visits, exchange and transit. Multiple entries. No application forms. **For 2027 departures, entry requirements will be whatever policy applies at the time you travel — CTS will tell you before departure if a visa is needed and will help with the application.**

WHAT TO BRING AT IMMIGRATION

- NZ passport with blank pages for stamps
- Return flight booking, dated within the permitted stay
- Proof of accommodation — your CTS tour itinerary can serve as proof
- Sufficient funds (credit cards plus some cash)

WHEN YOU STILL NEED A VISA

- Working in China → Z-Visa
- Study or internship → X-Visa
- Staying longer than the visa-free allowance → L-Visa
- Long-term residence → consult the Embassy

HOW TO BOOK

Deposit to confirm

A non-refundable deposit of **NZ$1,000 per person** confirms your tour booking (land-only stopovers: NZ$400 per person; bookings under NZ$1,000 per person are paid in full), payable within 3 working days of reserving. Your booking is not confirmed until CTS receives it. Full terms: ctstours.co.nz/terms-and-conditions.

YOUR MONEY IS PROTECTED

CTS Tours is a TAANZ member and all client funds sit in a **TAANZ-bonded trust account**. Card payments are processed through PCI-DSS compliant gateways.

TALK IT THROUGH

0800 CTS 888

info@ctstours.co.nz

CTS TOURS · AUCKLAND

Kiwi journeys to China, done properly.

PHONE

0800 CTS 888

0800 287 888 · Mon–Fri 9am–5pm

EMAIL

info@ctstours.co.nz

Reply within one working day

WEB

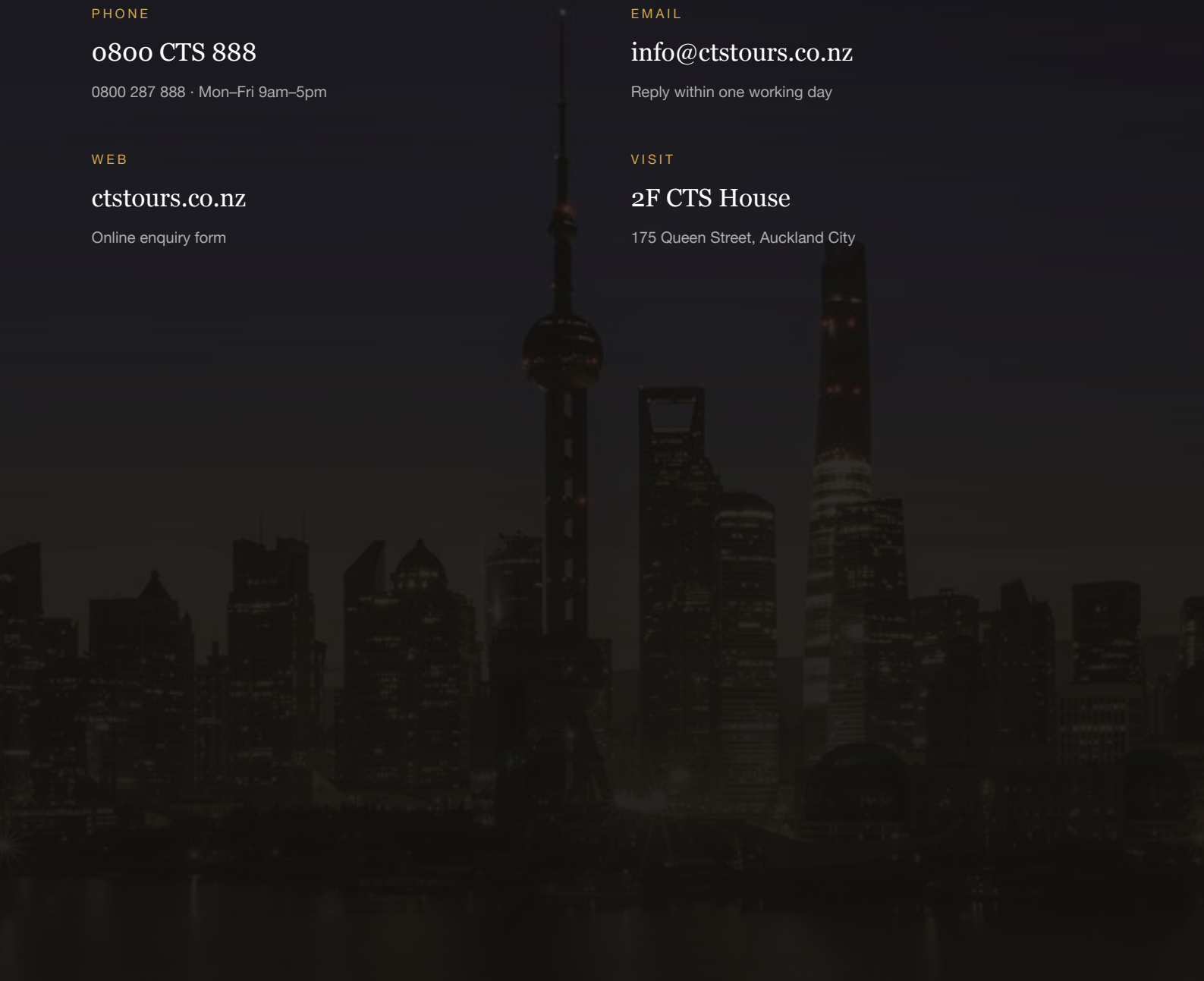
ctstours.co.nz

Online enquiry form

VISIT

2F CTS House

175 Queen Street, Auckland City



AUCKLAND-BASED · TAANZ-BONDED TRUST ACCOUNT · BACKED BY CHINA TRAVEL SERVICE

Prices, dates and inclusions in this brochure were checked against the CTS tour catalogue and ctstours.co.nz on 1 November 2026 and are per person in New Zealand dollars, twin share. Departures are scheduled group departures — confirm availability at booking. Google rating 4.4★ from 12 reviews, checked 1 November 2026.

Photography: Hongyadong, Chongqing — xiquinhosilva, CC BY 2.0 · Ciqikou old town, Chongqing — Nyx Ning, CC BY-SA 3.0 · West Lake in autumn, Hangzhou — 源義信, CC BY 4.0 · West Lake, Hangzhou — Jakub Hałun, CC BY-SA 4.0 · Muslim Quarter night market, Xi'an — chensiyuan, CC BY-SA 4.0. Remaining images © CTS Tours or used under the Unsplash licence.